The cultural mosaics of Asia and Europe are great eye openers for learners in terms of European and Asian cultures.

PART A. ASIA

Asia is the largest and the most populous continent in the world. It covers about 30 percent of the world's land area and about 60 percent of the world's population. Most of the land of Asia lies in the northern hemisphere. It has different types of physical and cultural features. Lofty mountains, plateaus, plains, islands and peninsulas are the major physiographic features of Asia. Many perennial rivers flow through different parts of Asia. These river valleys are the cradles of ancient civilizations (Indus valley, Mesopotamian and Chinese civilizations). Let us know more about our home continent.

Location and Area

Asia extends from 10°11' South to 81°12' North latitudes and from 26°2' East to 169°40' West, longitudes. It spreads for an area of 44 million km^2.

Boundaries

Asia is surrounded by the Arctic Ocean in the north, Pacific Ocean in the east, Indian Ocean in the south and the Ural Mountains, Caucasus Mountains, Red Sea, Mediterranean Sea, Caspian Sea and Black Sea in the west.

The Suez Canal separates Asia from Africa. The narrow Bering Strait separates Asia from North America.

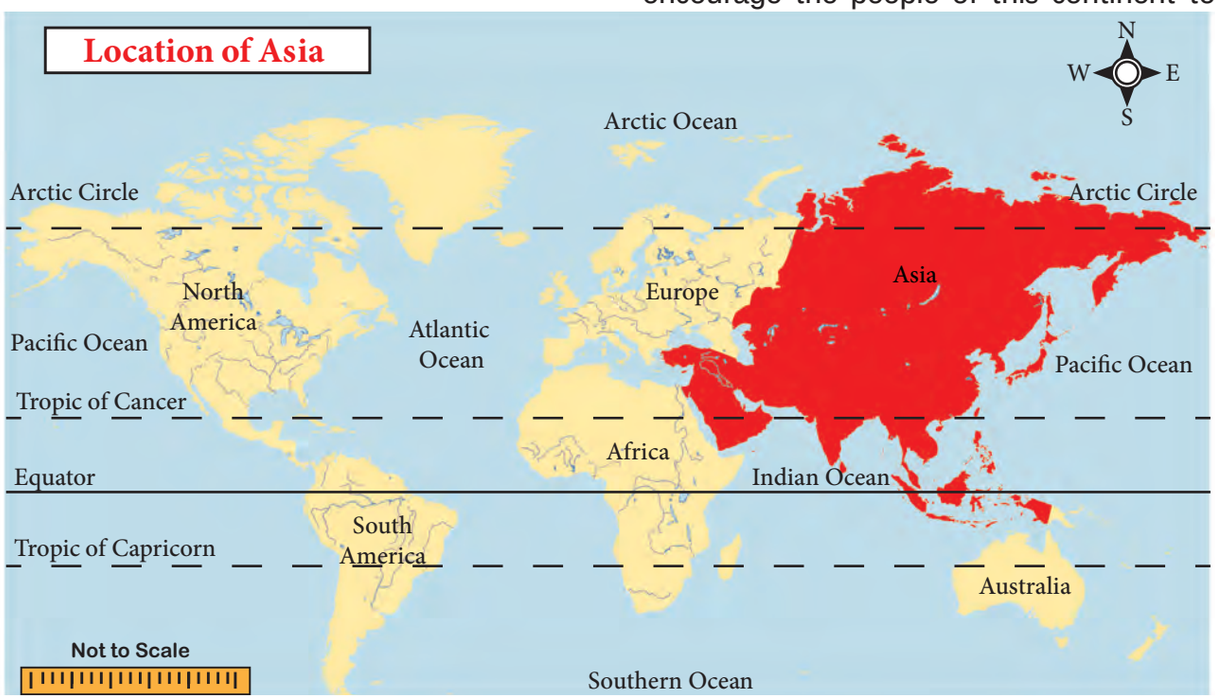
Political Divisions

There are forty eight countries in Asia. The countries are grouped into several realms based on landscape and political status such as

1.East Asia 2.Southeast Asia 3.South Asia 4.Southwest and 5.Central Asia

Physiographic Divisions

Asia is the land of long mountain ranges, snow capped high mountains, vast plateaus, extensive plains, river valleys and sea coasts. These diverse physical features encourage the people of this continent to



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